

DOCUMENT 28

STUDENT FELLOW OUTREACH COMMAND CENTER & DAILY OPERATING SYSTEM

Training Manual / SOP • Research → Personalize → Email → Call → LinkedIn → Follow Up → Track → Escalate

Mission: Turn the outreach prospect documents into confirmed community partners, sponsors, in-kind supporters, mentors, awareness partners and meetings for the Student Impact Challenge. Fellows are not measured by how many company names they look at. They are measured by disciplined, personalized outreach and properly tracked next actions.

THE GOLDEN RULE

Every prospect must have an owner, a reason for outreach, a clear ask, a next action and a follow-up date. “I emailed them” is not a completed task.

1. DAILY WORKFLOW

Time	Block	Required Action
9:00–9:20	Daily setup	Review yesterday's replies, meetings and follow-ups. Identify today's A1/A2 prospects.
9:20–10:45	Research & qualify	Research 10 new organizations. Find the correct decision-maker, official contact information, LinkedIn profile, fit and appropriate ask.
10:45–12:15	Personalized emails	Draft and send 10 individualized emails. Use AI to help personalize, but verify every fact before sending.
12:15–1:00	Tracker update / break	Record sent emails, contacts and next follow-up dates before moving on.
1:00–2:15	Phone outreach	Make 5–10 calls. Ask for the appropriate Community Relations, CSR/Social Impact, Foundation, Partnerships, Marketing, Public Affairs or local leadership contact.
2:15–3:00	LinkedIn research	Identify/contact at least 5 appropriate decision-makers. Do not spam executives.
3:00–4:00	Follow-up block	Complete at least 10 follow-ups from prior outreach. Change channel when useful: email → phone → LinkedIn.
4:00–4:40	Responses & escalation	Handle replies. Escalate meetings, sponsorship interest, contracts, significant donations and sensitive requests to leadership.
4:40–5:00	Closeout	Update 100% of today's records. Build tomorrow's priority queue and note blockers.

2. DAILY FELLOW SCORECARD

Activity	Daily Target
New qualified organizations researched	10
Personalized emails sent	10
Phone calls	5–10
LinkedIn decision-makers identified/contacted	5
Follow-ups completed	10
Tracker records updated	100%
Qualified opportunities escalated	Immediately

Quality beats empty volume. A generic email to 100 companies is not better than 10 researched contacts with the correct decision-maker and a credible reason to respond.

3. PRIORITY CLASSIFICATION

Code	Type	How to Treat It
A1	Major Funding Prospect	High-potential cash, scholarship or major program support. Research deeply and personalize.
A2	Strategic Partner	Can significantly expand credibility, awareness, student participation or access.

Code	Type	How to Treat It
B1	Local Cash Sponsor	Local/regional business with realistic community-marketing or sponsorship capacity.
B2	In-Kind / Prize Partner	Products, travel, technology, printing, food, services, experiences or prizes.
C1	Awareness / Distribution	Schools, libraries, churches, agencies, community groups and networks that can spread the word.
C2	Mentor / Experience	Professionals, universities, museums, companies and organizations offering speakers or career experiences.

4. HOW TO QUALIFY A PROSPECT

Step 1 — Understand the organization. What does it do? Where does it operate? Does it serve New York communities, young people, families, education, entrepreneurship, workforce development, technology, health, community improvement or another relevant mission?

Step 2 — Identify the fit. Decide whether the strongest opportunity is MONEY, IN-KIND, AWARENESS, EXPERIENCE, MENTORSHIP, VOLUNTEERS or a combination.

Step 3 — Find the right person. Search the official website first. Useful titles include Community Relations, Corporate Social Responsibility, Social Impact, Foundation, Partnerships, Public Affairs, Marketing, Government/Community Affairs, Education, Youth Programs, General Manager, Owner or Managing Partner.

Step 4 — Verify contact information. Record the official email, phone, contact page and LinkedIn. Do not invent email patterns. When uncertain, call the organization and ask who handles community partnerships or sponsorships.

Step 5 — Personalize. Write one or two sentences explaining specifically why that organization fits the challenge. AI can help draft; the fellow remains responsible for accuracy.

5. WHAT COUNTS AS A QUALIFIED LEAD?

Not qualified: “I emailed Nike.”

Qualified: “I identified the appropriate community-impact contact, verified the official outreach channel, sent a personalized message explaining the youth/community fit, recorded the contact in the tracker, and scheduled a follow-up. I also identified the office phone number if no reply arrives.”

A qualified opportunity becomes stronger when the organization replies, confirms the correct decision-maker, requests information, asks for a meeting, discusses contribution possibilities or introduces the fellow to another internal contact.

6. EMAIL OPERATING RULES

Subject: clear, professional and specific. Avoid clickbait. **Opening:** explain why you selected them. **Program:** summarize the Student Impact Challenge briefly. **Ask:** make one primary request. **Close:** ask for a short conversation or the correct contact. Keep initial outreach concise.

Attachments: Do not overload the first email. Attach a one-page program overview or flyer when it materially helps. A full media kit, sponsorship deck, detailed proposal, tax documentation or multiple PDFs should usually be sent after interest is established or when requested. Never send sensitive organizational documents casually.

AI: AI may help draft and personalize emails, subject lines and follow-ups. Fellows must verify company names, people, titles, claims, dates, prize amounts and program facts before sending. Never paste confidential information into an unapproved system.

7. PHONE CALL OPERATING RULES

The goal of the first call is usually **routing and qualification**, not a long sales pitch. State your name, the Student Impact Challenge, that you are seeking the person who handles community partnerships/sponsorships, and ask to be connected or given the correct contact information.

Record: person spoken to, title/department, direct phone if provided, email if provided, what they said, whether materials were requested and the exact next action.

8. LINKEDIN OPERATING RULES

Use LinkedIn primarily to **identify the right person and create a professional second channel**. Personalize connection messages. Do not repeatedly message executives, scrape private information, or represent a connection as an endorsement. When a contact asks to move to email, move the conversation to official email and update the tracker.

9. FOLLOW-UP SEQUENCE

Timing	Action	Purpose
Day 0	Initial personalized email	Record exact ask and follow-up date.
Day 2–3	Follow-up #1	Short reminder; add one useful fact or clearer ask.
Day 4–7	Phone call	Confirm correct department/contact; reference prior email.
Day 7–10	Follow-up #2	Use corrected contact or alternate channel.
Day 14	Final active follow-up	Politely close the loop and leave the door open.
Later	Recycle / nurture	Revisit only when there is a meaningful new reason, event or update.

10. ESCALATION — WHEN THE FELLOW STOPS AND LEADERSHIP TAKES OVER

Immediately escalate when a prospect requests or discusses: **a meeting with leadership; sponsorship amount or benefits; significant cash or in-kind contribution; contract/MOU; naming rights; exclusivity; logo/brand usage; media announcement; celebrity/athlete involvement; scholarships; travel; tax/W-9/501(c)(3) documents; insurance/COI; legal terms; student data; sensitive health/safety issues; government endorsement; or any request the fellow is not authorized to approve.**

Fellows do not negotiate contracts, promise benefits, guarantee publicity, authorize logo use, promise exclusivity, accept restricted donations, provide legal/tax advice, or make commitments on behalf of leadership.

11. MASTER TRACKER — REQUIRED FIELDS

1. Organization	2. Category / Industry
3. Priority Code	4. Fellow Owner
5. Contact Person	6. Title / Department
7. Official Email	8. Phone
9. LinkedIn	10. Website / Contact Page
11. Why They Fit	12. Primary Ask
13. Potential Cash / In-Kind Value	14. First Contact Date
15. Email Sent?	16. Called?
17. LinkedIn?	18. Follow-up #1
19. Follow-up #2	20. Last Contact Date
21. Response / Notes	22. Meeting Date
23. Proposal Requested/Sent	24. Current Stage
25. Next Action	26. Next Action Date
27. Escalated to Leadership?	28. Final Outcome

12. PIPELINE STAGES

Stage	Definition
1. Research	Prospect identified but not yet qualified.
2. Qualified	Correct fit and likely contact identified.
3. Contacted	Initial outreach completed.
4. Follow-Up	Active follow-up sequence underway.
5. Engaged	Two-way communication established.
6. Meeting	Meeting scheduled or completed.
7. Proposal / Ask	Specific support discussion underway.
8. Committed	Support verbally or formally indicated; leadership manages confirmation.
9. Confirmed	Required documentation/approval complete.
10. Closed / Nurture	Declined, no response after sequence, or revisit later.

13. WEEKLY KPI REVIEW

Each fellow should report: **new qualified prospects, personalized emails, calls, LinkedIn contacts, follow-ups, responses, qualified leads, meetings created, proposals requested, confirmed partners, cash sponsorship generated, estimated/confirmed in-kind value, awareness partners and stalled opportunities.** Leadership should review conversion rates—not only raw activity.

Useful conversion questions: Which industries reply most? Which subject lines and asks work? Which fellows are reaching decision-makers? How many contacted prospects become conversations? How many conversations become meetings? How many meetings become confirmed support?

14. PROFESSIONAL & YOUTH-SAFETY STANDARDS

Be truthful, respectful and concise. Do not exaggerate relationships, prize commitments, celebrity involvement, nonprofit status, media coverage or program reach. Protect student and family information. Never share participant lists with sponsors. Do not counsel students on legal, immigration, medical, mental-health, credit, tax or investment matters. Sensitive issues go to the designated adult/program leadership and qualified professionals.

15. END-OF-DAY CHECKLIST

Before leaving: **(1)** every email/call/LinkedIn action is logged; **(2)** every active prospect has a next action and date; **(3)** all replies are answered or assigned; **(4)** all leadership-level opportunities are escalated; **(5)** tomorrow's top prospects are selected; **(6)** no sensitive documents or participant data are sitting in personal notes, downloads or unapproved systems.

PROGRAM CONTACT

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